Bootstrap Navbar

In this lesson you will learn how to create static and fixed positioned responsive navigation headers using the Bootstrap navbar component.

Creating Navbar with Bootstrap

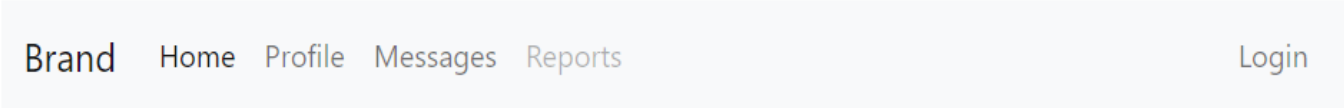
You can use the Bootstrap navbar component to create responsive navigation header for your website or application. These responsive navbar will be collapsed on devices having small viewports like mobile phones but expand when user click the toggle button. However, it will be horizontal as normal on the medium and large devices such as laptop or desktop.

You can also create different variations of the navbar such as navbars with dropdown menus and search boxes as well as fixed positioned navbar with much less effort. The following example will show you how to create a simple static navbar with navigation links.

Example

```
<nav class="navbar navbar-expand-lg navbar-light bg-light">
    <div class="container-fluid">
        <a href="#" class="navbar-brand">Brand</a>
        <button type="button" class="navbar-toggler" data-bs-toggle="collapse" data-bs-
        target="#navbarCollapse">
            <span class="navbar-toggler-icon"></span>
        </button>
        <div class="collapse navbar-collapse" id="navbarCollapse">
            <div class="navbar-nav">
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link active">Home</a>
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link">Profile</a>
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link">Messages</a>
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link disabled" tabindex="-1">Reports</a>
            </div>
            <div class="navbar-nav ms-auto">
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link">Login</a>
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
</nav>
```

— The output of the above example will look something like this:



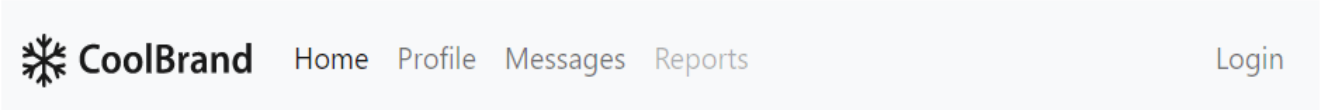
Adding Logo Images to Navbars

You can also place your logo image inside the navbar, instead of plain text. However, you need to set the logo height manually to fit it properly inside the navbar, as shown here:

Example

```
<nav class="navbar navbar-expand-lg navbar-light bg-light">
    <div class="container-fluid">
        <a href="#" class="navbar-brand">
            <img src="images/logo.svg" height="28" alt="CoolBrand">
        </a>
        <button type="button" class="navbar-toggler"
          data-bs-toggle="collapse" data-bs-target="#navbarCollapse">
            <span class="navbar-toggler-icon"></span>
        </button>
        <div class="collapse navbar-collapse" id="navbarCollapse">
            <div class="navbar-nav">
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link active">Home</a>
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link">Profile</a>
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link">Messages</a>
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link disabled"
                tabindex="-1">Reports</a>
            </div>
            <div class="navbar-nav ms-auto">
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link">Login</a>
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
</nav>
```

— The output of the above example will look something like this:



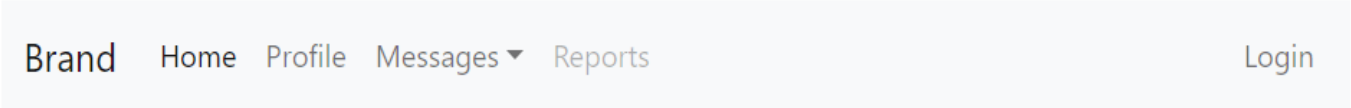
Adding Dropdowns to Navbar

You can also include dropdowns and search box within the navbars, as shown here:

Example

```
<nav class="navbar navbar-expand-lg navbar-light bg-light">
    <div class="container-fluid">
        <a href="#" class="navbar-brand">Brand</a>
        <button type="button" class="navbar-toggler"
              data-bs-toggle="collapse" data-bs-target="#navbarCollapse">
            <span class="navbar-toggler-icon"></span>
        </button>
        <div class="collapse navbar-collapse" id="navbarCollapse">
            <div class="navbar-nav">
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link active">Home</a>
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link">Profile</a>
                <div class="nav-item dropdown">
                    <a href="#" class="nav-link dropdown-toggle"
                     data-bs-toggle="dropdown">Messages</a>
                    <div class="dropdown-menu">
                        <a href="#" class="dropdown-item">Inbox</a>
                        <a href="#" class="dropdown-item">Sent</a>
                        <a href="#" class="dropdown-item">Drafts</a>
                    </div>
                </div>
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link disabled"
                 tabindex="-1">Reports</a>
            </div>
            <div class="navbar-nav ms-auto">
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link">Login</a>
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
</nav>
```

— The output of the above example will look something like this:



Placing Search Form inside Navbar

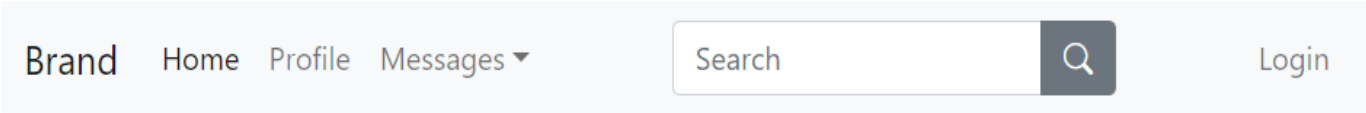
Search form is a very common component of the navbars and you have seen it on various website quite often. You can place various form controls within a navbar using the class `.d-flex` on the `<form>` element, as demonstrated in the following example:

Example

```
<nav class="navbar navbar-expand-lg navbar-light bg-light">
    <div class="container-fluid">
        <a href="#" class="navbar-brand">Brand</a>
        <button type="button" class="navbar-toggler"
             data-bs-toggle="collapse" data-bs-target="#navbarCollapse">
            <span class="navbar-toggler-icon"></span>
        </button>
        <div class="collapse navbar-collapse justify-content-between"
         id="navbarCollapse">
            <div class="navbar-nav">
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link active">Home</a>
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link">Profile</a>
                <div class="nav-item dropdown">
                    <a href="#" class="nav-link dropdown-toggle"
                       data-bs-toggle="dropdown">Messages</a>
                    <div class="dropdown-menu">
                        <a href="#" class="dropdown-item">Inbox</a>
                        <a href="#" class="dropdown-item">Sent</a>
                        <a href="#" class="dropdown-item">Drafts</a>
                    </div>
                </div>
            </div>
            <form class="d-flex">
```

```
                <div class="input-group">
                    <input type="text"
                            class="form-control"  placeholder="Search">
                    <button type="button"
                          class="btn btn-secondary">
                          <i class="bi-search"></i>
                    </button>
                </div>
            </form>
            <div class="navbar-nav">
                <a href="#" class="nav-item nav-link">Login</a>
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
</nav>
```

— The output of the above example will look something like this:



Changing the Color Scheme of Navbars

You can also change the color scheme of the navbar by using the `.navbar-light` for the light background colors, or `.navbar-dark` for the dark background colors.

Alternatively, you can also apply the CSS `background-color` property on the `.navbar` element yourself to customize the navbar theme, as shown in the following example:

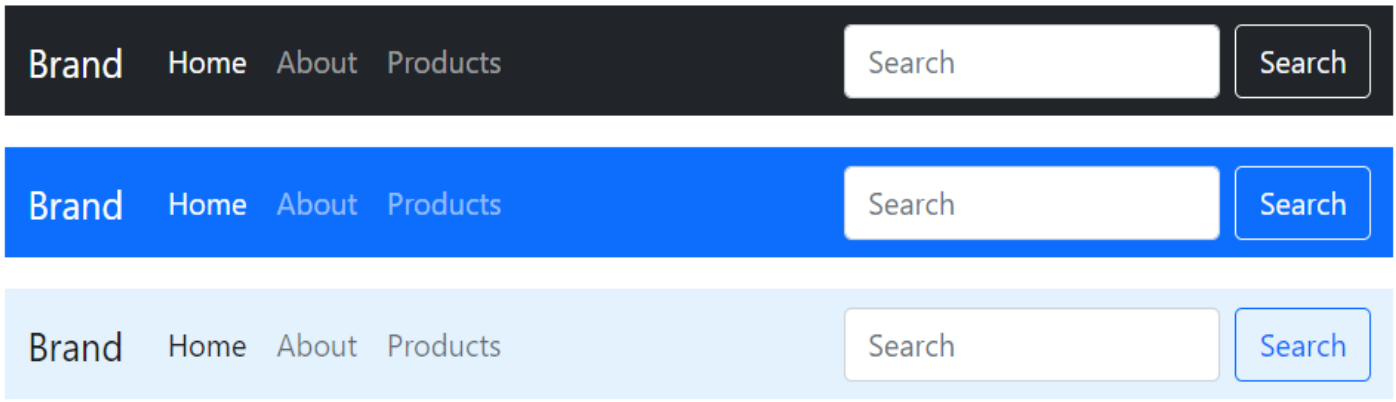
Example

```
<nav class="navbar navbar-dark bg-dark">
    <!-- Navbar content -->
</nav>

<nav class="navbar navbar-dark bg-primary">
    <!-- Navbar content -->
</nav>
```

```
<nav class="navbar navbar-light" style="background-color: #ddeeff;">
    <!-- Navbar content -->
</nav>
```

— The output of the above example will look something like this:



Bootstrap Fixed Navbars

Bootstrap also provides mechanism to create navbar that is fixed to the top, fixed to the bottom, or stickied to the top (i.e. scrolls with the page until it reaches the top, then stays there).

Navbar Fixed to the Top

Apply the position utility class `.fixed-top` to the `.navbar` element to fix the navbar at the top of the viewport, so that it won't scroll with the page. Here's an example:

Example

```
<nav class="navbar fixed-top navbar-expand-lg navbar-dark bg-dark">
    <!-- Navbar content -->
</nav>
```

Navbar Fixed to the Bottom

Similarly, add the class `.fixed-bottom` to the `.navbar` element to fix the navbar at the bottom of the viewport. It also won't scroll with the page. Let's see how it works:

Example

```
<nav class="navbar fixed-bottom navbar-expand-lg navbar-dark bg-dark">
    <!-- Navbar content -->
</nav>
```

Navbar Stickied to the Top

You can also create sticky top navbar that scrolls with the page until it reaches the top, then stays there, by simply using the `.sticky-top` class on the `.navbar` element, like this:

Example

```
<nav class="navbar sticky-top navbar-expand-lg navbar-dark bg-dark">
    <!-- Navbar content -->
</nav>
```